

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 707

By Johnson

A RESOLUTION to honor and congratulate the Battle Ground Academy girls' cross country team, 2025 TSSAA Division II, Class A state champions.

WHEREAS, it is appropriate that we honor those Tennessee students who, through their athletic prowess, have achieved the pinnacle of success and serve as exceptional ambassadors of the Volunteer State; and

WHEREAS, one such group of estimable individuals is the Battle Ground Academy girls' cross country team, which won the 2025 TSSAA Division II, Class A state championship, the first such title in school history; and

WHEREAS, state championships are achieved only through hard work, dedication, and the commitment to working together as a team and excelling with a cooperative spirit; the Battle Ground Academy Wildcats exhibited each of these rare qualities during their championship season; and

WHEREAS, the Battle Ground Academy girls' cross country team won the 2025 state title under the astute leadership of Coach Luke Johnson; and

WHEREAS, during the championship competition, held at Shelby Farms Park on November 6-7, 2025, the Wildcats displayed the tenacity, camaraderie, and skill befitting the state's finest athletic teams; and

WHEREAS, in the five-kilometer race, Julia Evans finished 5th in the state, Tibbie Cleveland finished 9th, Kiera Bray finished 14th, Libby Rothfuss finished 26th, Madeline Calkins finished 36th, Lola Padula finished 55th, and Grace Kaplan finished 57th; and

WHEREAS, all seven Battle Ground Academy athletes finished well within the top half of the 112-runner field; and

WHEREAS, Battle Ground Academy won their first-ever state championship a mere week after capturing the program's first-ever Middle Tennessee region title; and

WHEREAS, the Battle Ground Academy Wildcats' noteworthy achievement is a tremendous source of pride for their families, their classmates, and their entire community; and

WHEREAS, we find it appropriate to acknowledge and applaud the members of the girls' cross country team of Battle Ground Academy for serving as exemplars of the high quality of the youth of Tennessee; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor and congratulate the members and coaches of the Battle Ground Academy girls' cross country team on winning the 2025 TSSAA Division II, Class A state championship and extend to them our best wishes for continued success in all their future endeavors.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.